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Travel & Business Expense Reimbursement Policy

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1. PURPOSE

The purpose of this policy is to define the University of Miami (UM) travel and business expense reimbursement guidelines and procedures.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to University personnel, non-University personnel, and University students who participate in official University travel.

3. POLICY

It is the intent of this policy to encourage travelers to minimize travel expenses, consistent with University business requirements. It is to assist UM personnel by providing guidelines for travel and business expenses, mandatory documentation, required approvals and the process for reimbursement of authorized expenses.

The guidelines apply in general; however, schools, departments, or divisions may specify and enforce more restrictive travel and business expense policies and procedures. Additionally, travel and business expenditures on grants must be in accordance with the sponsor's guidelines if those guidelines are more restrictive than the University general policies and procedures. Refer to the Sponsored Programs Travel Expenses section of this policy for further detail.

Where a more standardized procurement method is available for purchases, the expense report should not be used. For example, purchase of University computers, computer parts, software, furniture, and capital equipment must be obtained via a purchase order. All pre-travel arrangements and bookings should adhere to this policy, the University of Miami Travel Policy and International Travel Policy. The University of Miami Payment Matrix serves as a guide for the payment methods to be used.

The University will not reimburse employee out-of-pocket expenses for materials and supplies that are reasonably available at the regularly assigned on-site work location. Expenses for other office supplies will not be reimbursed unless there is prior approval by the employee's supervisor. Supervisors may approve office supplies shipped directly to their remote employees when deemed reasonable. For additional information please the see the Remote Work Policy in Policy Stat.

4. DEFINITIONS

Allowable Expense: A necessary, reasonable, and appropriate expense incurred for the primary benefit of University business and therefore permitted to be reimbursed or directly charged based on the permission of the University or by the terms of the sponsored program agreements.

Business Purpose: Justification of how an expense is appropriate and reasonable, and how it supports and/or advances the goals and objectives of the University.

Cash Advance: An approved request of cash in hand that is given to the traveler prior to official University travel and is only to be used for University-related travel expenses.

Companion: Refers to a dependent, domestic partner, other family members, or any other individual accompanying an employee or authorized person who is conducting business on behalf of the University.

Concur: A self-service on-line booking tool that can be accessed through the Concur Travel Portal.

Domestic Travel: The General Services Administration defines domestic travel as travel within the United States, its possessions, and territories. U.S. possessions and territories include Guam, American Samoa, Puerto Rico, and the Virgin Islands.

Entertainment: An activity providing hospitality or recreation to University and non-University individuals that are necessary or customary in furthering the University's business. There must be a business purpose for entertainment expenses to be reimbursable.

Flight Time: Duration of time in the air and does not include layovers or change of planes.

Foreign/International Travel: Travel outside of the United States, its possessions, and territories. This includes travel within the United States while in route to, or returning from, foreign destinations.

Group Travel: For airfare, Group Travel is when 10 or more people are all traveling together and must be booked in the same reservation.

Local Travel: Travel within Miami-Dade County and Broward County.

Meeting Subsistence: Items such as bagels, beverages, donuts, or other small snacks for an office

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meeting. Meeting subsistence does not apply when an employee is in travel status.

Official (Business) University Travel: Official University travel is defined as travel by University personnel, non-University personnel, and University students when the authorizing individual considers such travel to be in the professional and/or business interest of the University.

One-Way Rentals: Automobile rentals returned to a location other than origin. These types of rentals may carry an additional fee or drop off charge imposed by the rental company.

Personal Expense: A non-University related expense for which the submitter will not be reimbursed.

Travelers: University employees, faculty, students, companions, consultants, job candidates, guest lecturers, University fellows and residents, and other non-employees/travelers that require travel for a UM business purpose.

Travel Management Department: The University's administrative department that is responsible for the travel guidelines outlined in this policy. The department manages the contractual relationship with World Travel Incorporated and the University Travel Portal.

University: University of Miami and its affiliates.

University Funds: Includes all sources of funds under the University's financial responsibility including operating, gifts, and grants.

University's Travel Portal: The University's preferred tool for making travel arrangements. Through the portal, University Travelers, Travel Assistants, and students can take advantage of both Concur and World Travel support to make airfare, car rentals and hotel business travel reservations.

University Travel Card: A credit card provided by U.S. Bank that is the preferred method of payment to be used for all University-related travel expenses.

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5. POLICY SECTIONS

This policy is intended to comply with external requirements including those of the Internal Revenue Service (IRS), federally or privately sponsored agreements, and the federal and state laws that govern a not-for-profit organization.

Below is an overview of the topics in this section.

1. Travel Expenses

    1a. Transportation Expense (including airfare, ground transportation and car rentals)

    1b. Lodging Expense

    1c. Meals Expense

    1d. Incidentals Travel Expenses

    1e. Non-University Employees & Student Travel

    1f. Sponsored Program Travel Expenses

2. Entertainment Expenses

3. Documentation & Approvals

3a. Documentation Requirements

3b. Expense Reports

3c. University Travel Card

3d. Travel Advances

3e. Insurance

3f. Approvals

3g. Reimbursable & Non-Reimbursable Items

1. Travel Expenses

1a. Transportation Expense

AIR TRAVEL

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The University strongly encourages faculty and staff travelers paying with University funds, as an Allowable Expense, to book through the University Travel Portal. Faculty and staff may book online through Concur or through our preferred Travel Agency.

Students whose travel is paid for with University funds, supported by the Student Activity Fee Allocation Committee (SAFAC), a University department or other clubs, are strongly encouraged to book airfare through the University's travel portal. This ensures duty of care which provides the University with awareness of all business, education, and research related travel in case of emergency situations and to provide necessary coordination and assistance. Should a student or student group not book through the University's travel portal, they must register their travel itinerary with International SOS (ISOS) (both domestic and foreign). For further information visit the University's travel portal.

Official (Business) University travel is to commence no more than one day prior to the event start and ends upon completion of the event. However, if no flights are available when the event ends, or overnight stay is required due to unreasonable flight hours, the University may reimburse the traveler for expenses up to one day after the event end date. A written justification is required to be included in the expense report to explain such circumstances.

Travelers, or their designated travel assistant, should make every reasonable effort to reserve the lowest available fare within two hours of the desired departure or arrival time.

When booking flight reservations, travelers must be aware of extra charges for certain seats within the economy/main cabin class. Seat upgrades within the Economy Class may be reimbursed at the department's discretion.

In-flight Wi-Fi is reimbursable while on University travel or with the business reason provided.

All travel must be by the most direct or economical route except in instances mentioned below.

To comply with the expense report submission and reconciliation requirements, airfare should be submitted for reimbursement through a separate expense report at the time of payment if the date of payment is more than 60 days from the completion of the trip.

Business Class

Business class (or equivalent) fares may be reimbursable under the following circumstances. If business class is not available, then an equivalent air fare may be substituted. Travelers must document the specific circumstances on the expense report. Failure to do so will delay processing of the expense report or can result in the denial of the expense.

- Business class tickets are approved for flights with over 5 hours of continuous flight time (excluding layovers and change of planes). Overnight rest stops or layovers do not qualify when determining if the flight time exceeds 5 hours total.
- Business class tickets are approved if no space is available in economy/main cabin class and the business reason for travel is urgent and cannot be postponed.
- The use of business class accommodations is approved if it is necessary to accommodate the traveler's disability or other special needs. This must be substantiated through a written statement by the traveler or, if possible, by a competent medical authority. This documentation must be included in the expense report.
- The use of business class accommodations is approved if required for security purposes or exceptional circumstances as determined by the appropriate Dean, Chair or Senior Business Officer/Senior Administrative Officer. Such approval by the respective authority must be included in the expense report.

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Premium Economy/Comfort Plus

Premium Economy/Comfort Plus may be reimbursable under the following circumstances. Travelers must document the specific circumstances on the expense report. Failure to do so will delay processing of the expense report or can result in the denial of the expense.

- Premium economy/comfort plus fare tickets are approved for flights with over 4 hours of continuous flight time (excluding layovers and change of planes). Overnight rest stops or layovers do not qualify when determining if the flight time exceeds 4 hours total.
- The use of premium economy/comfort plus accommodations is approved if it is necessary to accommodate the traveler's disability or other special needs. This must be substantiated through a written statement by the traveler or, if possible, by a competent medical authority. This documentation must be included in the expense report.
- The use of premium economy/comfort plus accommodations is approved if required for security purposes or exceptional circumstances as determined by the appropriate Dean, Chair or Senior Business Officer/Senior Administrative Officer. Such approval by the respective authority must be included in the expense report.

Baggage Fees

Standard airline charges for baggage are allowable. Excess baggage is reimbursable only when the business justification (evidencing reasonableness and necessity) is documented and submitted with the expense report.

Examples of reasonableness and necessity are as follows:

- Traveling with heavy and bulky materials required to complete the business reason for the travel;
- Traveling with equipment necessary for conducting business; and
- Traveling more than five (5) consecutive business days.

Baggage not included in tickets purchased in the University's travel portal, needs to be purchased directly with the appropriate airline.

International Travel

International SOS (ISOS)

The University has a Global Assistance Program, providing its international and domestic travelers with medical, security and travel assistance, which is managed and administered by ISOS. Travel itineraries, whether for international or domestic travel, booked through the University's travel portal will be directly uploaded into the ISOS program on behalf of the travelers. Travelers booking their trip outside the University's travel portal, must register their travel information along with any travel changes with ISOS.

For further information regarding international travel, please see the University's Travel Management website.

Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA)

Travelers should be aware that any facilitation payment to foreign officials, or generally anything of value to a foreign government official is considered a violation of FCPA.

Unused Airline Tickets

It is the traveler's responsibility to notify his or her supervisor and/or department head when an airline reservation results in an unused ticket and remains unused regardless of the reason.

All tickets booked through the University's travel portal or travel agency, and not used, will automatically be associated to the traveler's profile to be applied towards the next flight reservation if all rules are applicable and the same airline is being used. The travel agency can assist travelers with applying unused airline tickets. Unused airline tickets are non-transferable and therefore, they can only be reused on new flight reservations for the original travelers. Depending on the airline, additional fees to utilize unused tickets may be applied to the new transaction and the travel agent will facilitate with their expertise in making the most cost-effective new reservation when applying for an unused ticket.

The unused ticket must not be used for personal travel. Personal use of unused tickets constitutes theft of University resources and will result in restitution and disciplinary action up to and including

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termination.

Personal Travel

If business travel is extended with personal days, under no circumstances can the expenses related to personal days be included in the expense report.

Airfares submitted with an additional leg of travel not related to business or departing/returning to a different airport must be accompanied by an equivalent fare quote for the most direct route to the business destination obtained at the time of booking. Reimbursement is limited to the lesser airfare amount, leaving the remaining balance as the traveler's responsibility. Inability to provide a comparison quote will result in denial of the reimbursement request.

Example: Employee is traveling from Miami to New York for official University business. The employee, for personal travel, books their return trip from New York to New Orleans and then back to Miami. The expense report should include an airfare quote for a round trip ticket between Miami and New York. The reimbursement is limited to the lessor of the airfare quote or the actual cost paid by the employee for the airfare.

Non-Commercial Air Travel

Non-commercial air travel is prohibited without prior authorization from Risk Management. For additional information refer to the Non-Owned Aviation Liability Policy.

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GROUND TRAVEL

While traveling, it may be necessary to use multiple modes of ground travel (taxi, shuttle, Uber/Lyft). In these cases, travelers should exercise reasonable judgment and either use a University preferred supplier or the most economical ground travel option available. Travelers may use other services while using best judgment to ensure their safety and that of those traveling with them.

Commercial bus, rail, or vessel/steamship fares are reimbursed based on actual cost incurred by the traveler but are not to exceed the equivalent cost of economy/main cabin airfare through normally traveled routes.

PERSONAL AUTOMOBILE

The use of personal automobiles for travel will be reimbursed when the round-trip number of miles driven for any one trip is 1,000 miles or less. It is the intent of the policy for travelers to fly to their location, when mileage exceeds 1,000 miles. The maximum number of miles reimbursed will be 1,000 miles for trips exceeding this distance.

Travel by private automobile will be reimbursed based on the IRS standard mileage allowance in effect at the time of the travel. The University's standard rate per mile includes insurance, gas, oil, wear, and tear. Refer to the mileage reimbursement information here.

If two or more people are traveling in the same car, only one person can claim mileage reimbursement.

Where the employee has a temporary assignment away from campus, reimbursement will be made for

mileage between either the campus and the assignment location or between the traveler's home and the assignment location, whichever is less. The University will not reimburse employees for commuting expenses between home and campus.

Unless otherwise approved, the driver of a private vehicle must be a licensed driver, at least 21 years of age and covered under a policy which includes comprehensive and liability insurance. Damage to personal automobiles used on official business is considered to be covered by private insurance. The University does not assume liability for deductibles or any other uninsured loss to the vehicle.

Any person authorized to travel on University business may choose to use his or her personal automobile but does so at his or her own risk and is personally responsible for all costs of operation, including repairs to the automobile, towing expenses, access charges for lost keys, parking fines or missed toll charges, and for public liability and property damage.

CAR RENTALS

Reservations

Before renting a car, the traveler should consider other less costly means of transportation (i.e., shuttle services, ride services, carpooling, and taxis). It is highly recommended that car rental reservations be made using the University's travel portal which utilizes the University contracted rates with University's preferred car rental companies. For assistance, travelers or travel assistants may contact the University's travel agency.

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Rental Class

Vehicle types and sizes may be rented as necessary for business travel related purposes. Travelers should make every reasonable effort to rent the lowest available rate, whenever possible. Cars should be returned with a full tank of gas to avoid unnecessary surcharges for fuel. Truck rentals are not available through the University's travel portal.

Rental Insurance

The University requires all car rentals used for the purpose of business travel to be insured. Some University contracted car rental rates may be inclusive of insurance when renting in the United States and Puerto Rico. It is the traveler’s sole responsibility to confirm if rates include the required insurance. If not, travelers must purchase collision damage waiver/loss damage waiver (CDW/LDW) and basic liability insurance. Rental insurance cannot be purchase through the University's travel portal or travel agent. The traveler must purchase it at the time of pick-up or by contacting the car rental company.

The traveler is responsible for purchasing insurance for vehicles rented for personal or leisure use. When renting for personal/leisure use the renter assumes responsibility for all loss or damage done to the rental vehicle, up to and included the full value of the rental vehicle, regardless of fault.

Any employee involved in an accident while driving a vehicle rented for University business must immediately report the accident to the local police and rental agency as well as UM Risk Management at (305) 284-3163. Email: riskmanagement@miami.edu

1b. Lodging Expense

Hotel Reservations and Cancellation

Hotel reservations should be made using the University's travel portal. The University's travel portal will display the University's negotiated hotel rates and reservations should be at the lowest rate available for the planned itinerary. Hotel cancellations must be addressed as soon as changes are known and must be communicated to Travel Management. Hotel cancellation charges and processing fees will be charged accordingly. A travel agent may aid with hotel bookings through the University's travel agency.

If the business purpose for travel is to a conference and the conference is offering a hotel conference rate, travelers are encouraged to book through this option without the need to use the University's travel portal.

Hotel Class

Travelers should use standard accommodations in reasonably priced hotels. When requesting reimbursement, an electronic copy of the itemized hotel bill must be attached to the expense report. The bill should show that it has been fully paid prior to submission for reimbursement.

Rental Accommodations (e.g., AirBNB, VRBO, etc.)

University employees are authorized to use rental accommodations for University business activities where necessary. Documentation to support the cost savings must be submitted with the expense report. Employees are strongly encouraged to utilize traditional forms of lodging (i.e., standard room in a reasonably priced hotel). Rental accommodations such as Airbnb and VRBO may not be licensed and may not comply with city code, safety, and other requirements.

Students are not authorized to use Airbnb and VRBO. See section below for further information.

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1c. Meals Expense

Federal regulations require that the reimbursement of meal expenses, including gratuities, be requested on either an actual cost or an allowance (per diem) basis. The method used must be applied to the entire trip and not to select days of the trip.

Actual Cost Basis

Under the actual cost basis, the maximum limit per person (including gratuities) is:

A. Breakfast: $30
B. Lunch: $40
C. Dinner: $75

Departments may choose lower limits or require the use of the allowance (per diem) basis. Travelers should confirm with their respective departments for such limitations or specifications.

Allowance (Per Diem) Basis

Domestic Travel Allowance (Per Diem)

The University reimburses travelers for meal expenses incurred during domestic travel based on the per diem allowance rates published by the General Services Administration (GSA) and Department of Defense (DOD).

The GSA establishes per diem rates for destinations within the Continental United States (CONUS). For more information and rates refer to GSA Per Diem Rates.

DOD establishes non-foreign rates such as Alaska, Hawaii, Puerto Rico, and Guam. For more information on non-foreign rates refer to DOD Per Diem Rate Lookup.

A meal allowance is paid only when the traveler is away from the local area overnight or when attending an approved event in the local area that requires overnight stay at the event hotel. The local area is defined as Miami-Dade or Broward counties. Justification describing the circumstances that require overnight stay must be included in the expense report.

The per diem meal rate is inclusive of gratuities.

For multiple city trips, the per diem location is based on the city in which the traveler spends the night. Only 75% of the daily allowance is available on the day of departure and day of return.

The per diem meal allowance is also reduced for meals provided by the conference or seminar. When submitting the expense report in Workday, meals provided by the conference or seminar will need to be deducted from the daily allowance.

The per diem meal allowance must be reduced for any meal consumed as part of an entertainment expense.

When completing the daily meal allowance request in Workday, please check the box indicating the appropriate meal(s) provided.

For domestic travel meals already provided, Workday reduces the Meals and Incidentals as follows:

- Breakfast: 24%
- Lunch: 26%
- Dinner: 50%

International Travel Allowance (Per Diem)

The University reimburses travelers for meal expenses incurred during international travel based on the Department of State rates. For more information on foreign rates refer to U.S. Department of State Office of Allowance.

For multiple city trips, the per diem location is based on the city in which the traveler spends the night. Only 75% of the daily allowance is available on the day of departure and day of return.

The per diem meal allowance is also reduced for meals provided by the conference or seminar. When

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submitting the expense report in Workday, meals provided by the conference or seminar will need to be deducted from the daily allowance.

The per diem meal allowance must be reduced for any meal consumed as part of an entertainment expense.

For international travel meals already provided, Workday reduces the Meals and Incidentals as follows:

- Breakfast: 19%
- Lunch: 31%
- Dinner: 50%

1d. Incidental Travel Expenses

Incidental Travel Expenses

Incidental expenses include, but are not limited to, items such as tolls, bus, taxis, ride-share, airport shuttle, train, parking or other public transportation expenses, business related telephone calls, baggage handling, and gratuities (non-meal related). For international travel, international phone charges may be reimbursed but can **not** be charged to a sponsored account. The guideline for gratuities is 15% to 20% of the service.

Please note that gratuities are included in the actual cost and per diem amounts noted above. Meal expense related gratuities cannot be claimed as an additional or separate incidental reimbursement.

1e. Non-University Employees & University Student Travel

Reimbursement of travel expenses for purposes such as employment interviews, visits to the University by lecturers and other official visitors are subject to the same travel policies and procedures in effect for employee travel as stated in this policy.

The department arranging the travel is responsible for informing non-University employees and University students of the requirements contained in this policy prior to making travel arrangements. The department is also responsible for having all forms properly completed and processed with the necessary supporting documentation attached with the submission.

Reimbursement to non-University employees for University approved travel expenses must be requested through the Non-Employee/Student Expense Reimbursement Form. This form must also be used to reimburse University students who are not employees for out-of-pocket expenses incurred in direct support and benefit of a faculty (research) project or for activities of a University recognized student club or organization.

Payment for work as an employee must be paid through payroll in Workday.

All other payments such as awards, stipends, and prizes, have the potential to affect the student's financial aid and must be processed through the Office of Student Financial Assistance and Employment

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(OSFAE). For more information on payments to University students, see Payments to Student policy.

Students are not authorized to use Airbnb and VRBO. Students must reserve lodging accommodations with a hotel when traveling on behalf of the University. For exception approvals, the student business office must contact the Risk Management Department prior to booking reservations and include the written approval with the expense report. Risk Management can be reached at (305) 284-3163 or email: riskmanagement@miami.edu

Alcohol is not a permissible expense for students. Please see the Student Rights and Responsibilities Handbook policy for further information.

Companion Travel

Transportation, lodging, or meal expenses for non-employees which include spouses, dependents, or others who accompany the traveler may be reimbursed only when there is a clear and direct benefit to the University. Authorization for companion travel should be approved prior to booking reservations. Companion travel expenses must be reconciled on the University employee's expense report.

The non-business incidental travel cost of a non-employee companion traveler if approved and reimbursed, will be reported with wages, salary and other pay included in Box 1 of the employee's Form W-2 and subject to applicable taxes. For a non-employee traveler seeking reimbursement for their companion, a W-9 is needed to facilitate 1099 reporting for the expenses not meeting the Accountable Plan requirements.

House hunting expenses are taxable if reimbursed.

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1f. Sponsored Programs Travel Expenses

Travel expenses incurred under a sponsored program and charged to a grant related account may have additional requirements and restrictions. Refer below for specific travel expense regulations for sponsored programs. Ahead of travel, travelers should consult with the appropriate post-award administration team for expenditure compliance questions. For contact information, refer to the ORA Contact site.

When a travel expense is charged to a sponsored grant or contract, the explanation should include the relationship of the travel expense to the project. Receipts on sponsored grants should follow the guidelines of the granting agency.

All expense reports require the final approval of the Disbursements Office or the Office of Research Administration (ORA), if expenses are charged to a grant related account.

Air Carriers for All Federally Funded Travel

Under the Fly America Act, all federally funded air travel and cargo transportation services are required to use a 'U.S. flag' air carrier service. As such, U.S. flag air carriers must be used from the point of origin to destination. If there are no U.S. flag carrier services to the destination, such service must be used to the farthest interchange point. U.S flag air carriers are to be selected regardless if the fare is more expensive or the route to the destination is more circuitous. Traveler preference and convenience are not valid

exceptions for use of a non-U.S. flag carrier when travel is federally funded.

The traveler is responsible for justifying the use of non-U.S. flag carriers before the expense report is submitted utilizing an approved exception list on the Fly America Act site. The U.S. government does not allow code sharing unless the ticket is issued by a U.S. airline. It is strongly encouraged that the traveler consult with their ORA Contact before tickets are purchased.

Sponsored Program Ground Travel

The mileage allowance permitted to be charged to a State of Florida sponsored grant or contract is less than the University's standard allowance. Please review Florida State Statutes current mileage rates.

Sponsored Program Incidentals

Receipts for incidentals below $75.00 may be required for grants if the sponsor's policies indicate this requirement.

Sponsored awards issued by the State of Florida are subject to the Reference Guide for State Expenditures which can require **all** receipts for certain incidentals regardless of the amount (e.g. baggage fees) and receipts for other incidentals over $25.00. Refer to current Reference Guide for State Expenditures for full guidance.

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State of Florida Grants allowance per diem requirements:

State of Florida grants have unique reimbursement stipulations for per diem rates. The maximum meal reimbursement for a 24-hour period is $36.00.

Meals are reimbursed when travel is at least 50 miles away (one way) from the office as follows:

- Breakfast: $6.00; departure before 6:00 am and return after 8:00 am
- Lunch: $11.00; departure before noon and return after 2:00 pm
- Dinner $19.00; departure before 6:00 pm and return after 8:00 pm.

A State of Florida Voucher for Reimbursement of Travel Expense (Form AA-15) must be attached to the expense report. The hours of departure and return must also be included in the expense report.

Sponsored Program Entertainment Expenses

Entertainment expenses are not allowable charges to most sponsored agreements. Alcohol charges are not allowable on any sponsored grant or contract. If a group meal is charged to a sponsored grant or contract, the benefit to the grant or contract must be included in the explanation (i.e. explanation of how the group meal furthers the work under the sponsored agreement). It is strongly encouraged that the the employee consult with their ORA Contact before incurring any entertainment expenses to ensure it's allowable.

2. Entertainment Expenses

Entertainment expenses, including meals and receptions, must be reasonable and have a clear business purpose to be reimbursable. The maximum limit per person is as follows:

- Breakfast: $45
- Lunch: $75
- Dinner: $150

Alcohol is ONLY permitted at dinner and should be limited as much as possible. Exceptions may be allowed for donor cultivation and recruitment. *Alcohol purchases for events must be approved by Risk Management PRIOR to purchase*.

The date of the entertainment expense and the business topics discussed or business purpose for the entertainment need to be entered in the expense report.

Documentation Requirements:

Reimbursement requests for entertainment expenses should be submitted through an expense report. The expense report must include the date of the entertainment expense and the business topics discussed or business purpose for the entertainment. Additionally, the expense report must include the following documentation:

- The original itemized receipt. Monthly credit card statements alone are not acceptable as backup documentation. While traveling, receipts are not required if less than $75. To be considered traveling, your trip must include an overnight stay away from home.
- Small groups (up to and including 10 people) require the following:
    A. Names of persons entertained and their relation to the University or other affiliation.
- Large Groups (more than 10 people) require the following:
    A. Identifying each attendee by name or
    B. Identifying the group by a recognizable or known group name and including the number in attendance (e.g. Department of Law Faculty for 25; Disbursement's Office for 15; etc.)
- Catering Requests submitted to on-campus vendors should be processed through a Purchase Order. For more information please visit the Supply Chain website.

Additional documentation may be requested if the relationship is not clearly indicated.

Alcohol is ONLY permitted at dinner and should be limited as much as possible. Exceptions may be allowed for donor cultivation and recruitment. *Alcohol purchases for events must be approved by Risk Management PRIOR to its purchase*.

Reimbursement of entertainment expenses must be charged to the appropriate entertainment expense items in Workday. Meeting subsistence (i.e. snacks, coffee, etc. provided as part of a meeting) is not

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considered an appropriate entertainment expense item while traveling on University business. Meeting subsistence **cannot** be claimed while in travel status.

Payment to third parties for services, such as servers, musicians, and guest speakers, should not be paid by employees and should be processed using the check request process in Workday and comply with IRS Form W-9 requirements (see Check Request Policy). Failure to submit the required W-9 will result in the reimbursement being reportable along with wages, salary and other pay included in Box 1 of the requesting employee's Form W-2 and subject to applicable taxes.

Gifts to employees for the purposes of engagement, appreciation, recognition, etc. are not considered entertainment expenses. Refer to Non-Reimbursable Expenses below for further information.

Entertainment Expenses - Purchased Tables & Sponsorship

Expenses incurred for the purchase of tables or seats for University and non-University events as well as purchasing sponsorships are to follow the request and approval process outlined in the UM Purchased Tables & Sponsorship policy.

3. Documentation & Approvals

3a. Documentation Requirements

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In accordance with IRS Publication 15, Section 5, the University has an "Accountable Plan" for employee business expense reimbursements. Under an accountable plan, expenses are required to meet three conditions:

1. There must be a legitimate business purpose.
2. Must be substantiated (receipts/appropriate documentation) within a reasonable period of time.
3. Any excess amounts of cash advance not used must be returned.

Expenses not meeting all three conditions may be taxable and therefore subject to IRS W-2 or 1099-MISC reporting.

Business related expenses under IRS rules are those which would be eligible for an employee deduction on his or her tax return if the employee paid for them out of pocket.

To satisfy substantiation requirements, all reimbursements must include an explanation of the business purpose for the expense and original receipts detailing the date, place, and amount of the expense.

When you are traveling, receipts less than $75 are not required unless they are for car rental, lodging or airfare.

3b. Expense Reports

Expense reports are utilized by University employees, including student employees, to obtain reimbursement of personal funds used and/or to account for the amounts expended on the University travel card. All expenses incurred while in travel status on official business of the University must be

accounted for on an expense report in Workday. Each trip should have its own expense report. Multiple trips should not be combined into one expense report. Failure to comply with the University's travel policy may result in a delay or denial of reimbursement.

If more than one person is traveling on the same trip, each traveler must submit their own expense report for expenses they incurred.

The reimbursement of non-travel business expenses requires the submittal of an expense report. Consistent with travel related expenses, non-travel also requires electronic copies of receipts as well as an explanation of the business purpose for the expense. Reimbursement will not be granted if proper documentation has not been received.

Submission & Reconciliation of Expense Reports

Effective for expenses incurred or paid on March 1, 2025 or later, all expense reports must be reconciled and submitted within **60 days of when the expenses were incurred or paid** to comply with IRS guidelines. Any expenses reports not submitted within 60 days of when the expenses were incurred or paid will **not** be reimbursed by the University.

Exceptions may be made for extenuating circumstances. A detailed explanation of such circumstances should be submitted for approval by the submitting department's Executive Vice President (or equivalent) of the University. The approval must be included with the expense report submission. In such circumstances, expenses reimbursed after 60 days will be reportable along with wages, salary and other pay included in Box 1 of the employee's Form W-2 and subject to applicable taxes as in accordance with IRS Publication 463.

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Foreign Currency Considerations

When requesting reimbursement of foreign travel expenses, the foreign currency rates used to convert to the U.S. dollar (USD) must be included. If a University travel card is used, the rates should be those used by the credit card company at the time of the transaction and not the rates in effect at the time the expense report is submitted.

If a University Travel Card was not used, refer to the OANDA Currency Converter to find the conversion rate for the day the expense was incurred. A screen shot of each conversion must be attached to the expense report along with other applicable backup documentation.

If a personal credit card was used, submit the reimbursement for the USD amount on the credit card statement and include the redacted statement as a backup

Expense Reports - Backup Documentation Requirements

Expense reports should be submitted in Workday and include detailed documentation to support the expenses. Please note that monthly credit card statements alone are not acceptable as backup documentation. The following documentation based on the type of travel expense incurred is also required:

For all air travel purchases, one of the following should be provided as a receipt and submitted with the

expense report:

- a screen print of the purchase confirmation and itinerary; or
- copy of the e-mail confirmation and itinerary received from the airline or travel agency.

This documentation must provide details of flights, destination, and payment and must be submitted with the reimbursement request.

For hotel stays, an electronic copy of the itemized hotel bill showing the expenses have been fully paid prior to requesting reimbursement must be included.

For attendance at seminars and conferences, a copy of the agenda with conference dates should be attached to the expense report.

For bus, rail, and vessel reimbursements, the original ticket receipt, confirmation notice, or travel agency invoice detailing destination and payment must be attached to the expense report.

For the use of personal automobiles for travel, the actual number of miles driven is required. A printout of Google Maps or other similar site is required to support the miles driven. If requesting reimbursement for multiple trips, a mileage log may be submitted that includes the business purpose for each leg of the trip.

For car rentals, a copy of the detailed receipt showing booking dates, car type, and proof of payment from the car rental agency must be attached to the expense report.

If you are traveling, receipts for transportation expenses such as tolls, parking, bus, train, and ride-share, business related telephone calls, baggage handling, and gratuities are not required for reimbursement if less than $75.00. To be considered traveling, your trip must include an overnight stay away from home.

Receipts for local tolls and parking to attend a local meeting or conference are not required if less than $75.00.

For meals accounted for using actual cost (not an allowance/per diem), an electronic copy of the credit card receipt and the itemized restaurant bill must be attached to the expense report. Receipts are not required for meal reimbursement for travel-related expenses under $75.00 (including gratuities). To be considered traveling, your trip must include an overnight stay away from home.

Reimbursement for travel by non-University employees and University Student requires electronic copies of all receipts for hotel, car rental, and airfare are required. For other expenses, only receipts $75 or greater are required. Conference agendas are also required.

Reimbursement

A delay in reimbursement may occur if the expense report is not complete or if the required documentation as listed above is not provided.

Reimbursements of approved out-of-pocket or non-travel card expenses are directly deposited to the employee's designated bank account after the expense report receives final approval.

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3c. University Travel Card

The Travel Card is a corporate credit card, available only to full-time employees that travel on University business. It provides a convenient method to pay for business expenses while traveling, without using personal funds.

Travel card expenses are paid by the University directly to U.S. Bank. Employees must reconcile travel card charges timely, as stipulated in the Travel Card Agreement. The travel card is reconciled through the expense report business process in Workday. For more information, refer to the Travel Card website for further details and links to the agreement.

It is the responsibility of the cardholders to reconcile all University expenses charged to the card via the expense report in Workday within sixty (60) days from the date the expense was incurred or paid. Failure to do so will result in expenses being non-reimbursable. See the section above for further detail.

The cardholders are also responsible for ensuring that expenses are fully substantiated according to this policy. For step-by-step guidance on reconciling travel card transactions, please refer to the "Need help" selection in Workday located on the top of the Workday page. A ULearn is available to understand the process of how to perform expense reimbursement in Workday. Refer to the University's ULearn page and search for 'Workday: Expenses'.

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3d. Travel Advances

A travel advance, or cash advance, is an approved request of cash in hand that will be used by the traveler to pay for expenses related to a future University-related business event and cannot be used as reimbursement for expenses already paid.

The University travel card should be used for expenses incurred while traveling. However, travel advances are available to University employees under certain circumstances.

Travel advances in the form of a direct deposit or check are made available only in cases of:

- Travel to locations where the University Travel Card is not accepted;
- Group travel that requires the payment of a daily allowance to students; or
- Unusual or special circumstances as approved by the Disbursements Office.

University Employee Travel Advances

Travel advances to be paid to University employees must be entered and processed through the Spend Authorization business process in Workday. This includes student group travel that is to be paid to a University employee who is the acting chaperon for the trip. Travel advances for cash will not be issued more than ten working days before the approved travel.

Travel advances must be accounted for on an expense report within ten working days of the traveler's return to work. An exception exists when the traveler must leave for another trip within the ten working days following return from the earlier trip.

Failure to provide proper documentation of advances or provide the documentation timely may result in

the University including such advances along with wages, salary and other pay included in Box 1 of the employee's Form W-2 and therefore subject to applicable taxes. Additionally, the University may withhold the amount of the travel advance from the employee's wages or other money due to the employee.

Any unused portion of a cash advance must be returned to the University by making a deposit at the Cashier's Office on the Coral Gables campus or with the department's corresponding business office. The deposit must contain a reference to the spend authorization and proof of deposit must be attached as backup documentation when reconciling the travel advance in the expense report.

New cash advances will not be issued to travelers with outstanding advances.

Documentation Requirements

A detailed justification for the amount requested is required as well as a completed Travel Advance Request form.

3e. Insurance

Insurance is provided, under the Workers' Compensation Plan. The policy covers employees traveling on official University business trips that originate from home or the University, whichever is the case. Coverage is also provided for University employees on University business if the expenses are paid in whole or part by a non-University source.

The University will not, under any circumstances, bear the cost of any personal travel insurance coverage or trip protection purchased by the traveler.

Partial insurance coverage is also provided to University travel cardholders who use their travel card to pay for transportation related travel expenses. Employees are covered during local travel if there is a record (on calendar, staff verification, or other means of recording) that the local travel is University related.

As stipulated in the U.S. Bank Worldwide Automatic Common Carrier Travel Accident Insurance Policy, certain fees such as use, depreciation and administrative fees, are not covered by the University travel card. Loss of use and depreciation are claimed by rental companies when the vehicle is out of use due to damage repairs.

When travelers are renting automobiles, they are required to purchase CDW/LDW. CDW/LDW covers any damages to the vehicle, as well as loss of use and depreciation fees. Travelers are also required to purchase Basic Liability coverage which covers any third-party damages that the renter may become liable for as a result of an accident or incident. Third-party damages include bodily injury and property damage.

Some University contracted car rentals rates reserved through the University's travel portal may be inclusive of insurance when renting in the United States and Puerto Rico. It is the traveler's sole responsibility to confirm if rates include the required insurance.

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3f. Approvals

Approval requests are automatically routed to the appropriate person(s) within Workday.

- For all amounts, the Cost Center Manager's approval is required.
- For amounts $10,000 or greater, the Senior Business Manager's approval is required.
- The Accounts Payable & Disbursements department will be the final approver for all expense reports over $300.
- For expense reports created on behalf of a traveler, the traveler's approval is required.
- A traveler's manager or his/her designee is required to approve.
- All expense reports that are charged to a grant account will be reviewed and approved by the ORA and require the final approval of the Disbursements Office or ORA.
- Approval by the Senior Vice President & Dean of the Medical School is required for all expense reports submitted by his/her direct reports.
- Prior travel approval may be required by schools, departments, divisions, or sponsored programs.

Policy exceptions must be approved by the submitting department's Executive Vice President (or equivalent) of the University. For any school's or colleges' departments, approval must be first routed through the respective Dean prior to approval by the Executive Vice President. Exceptions must be requested by the department in writing via email and approved **prior** to incurring the expense. The approved email should be attached to the expense report. If there are questions regarding the appropriate approval for exception requests, please reach out to the Accounts Payable department.

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3g. Reimbursable & Non-Reimbursable Items

Below are examples of common reimbursable and non-reimbursable items. Please note that this list is not comprehensive. If there are questions regarding the allowability of specific items, please reach out directly to either the Accounts Payable department or ORA (if grant or sponsored program related).

Reimbursable Expenses

- Baggage fees
- Fees for the purchase of traveler's checks
- Internet access, telephone calls, and faxes for business purposes
- Laundry charges if travel is five nights or more
- Parking and tolls
- Fees related to passports, visas, immunizations, foreign driving permits and currency conversion
- UHealth workers' travel expenses to campus with a Work Arrangement Type 100% Remote. Note: a screenshot of the Workday Flexible Work Arrangements must be attached to the expense report.

Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Airline tickets obtained using frequent flyer miles, travel vouchers or airline points
- Clothing and clothing rentals
- Commuting between home and campus
- Trips to campus by remote workers (outside the UHealth 100% remote type noted above).
- Employee UM parking permits or fees
- Furniture
- Gifts to friends or relatives given in lieu of meals and lodging
- Hotel "no-show" charges, airline, hotel, or car rental cancellation fees due to negligence of the traveler
- Laundry charges, if travel is less than five nights or traveler is on foreign per diem meal allowance
- Life or travel accident insurance premiums
- Memberships to social clubs (e.g., golf, health, or airline travel clubs) unless approved by an Executive Vice President of the University
- Other expenses not directly related to the travel assignment
- Parking tickets and traffic violations
- Personal care items
- Personal entertainment such as hotel room movies, theater tickets, newspapers, magazines, prescriptions, over the counter drugs, health club facilities, barber/beautician services, etc.
- Personal portion of airfare, hotel, or rental car
- Relocation or moving expenses. Note: the correct procedure is to submit a "One-Time Payment" via Payroll
- Rentals of convertible automobiles or other non- standard vehicles
- Repairs or towing of personal vehicle
- Personal travel insurance coverage or trip protection purchased by the traveler
- Uber, Lyft or other ride share company rides paid for with vouchers or points.
- Gifts to employees for the purposes of engagement, appreciation, recognition, etc. Such gifts are subject to the University Gifts and Discounts to Employees policy. Please refer to the linked policy for further information regarding applicability, methods of reimbursement and approvals.
- Gift cards are not reimbursable unless for the purposes of research participant payments. For further information regarding research participant payments please refer to the Controller's Office website.
- Expenses submitted for reimbursement more than 60 days after expenses were incurred or paid

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All Revision Dates

01/2025, 01/2024, 07/2023, 11/2022, 09/2017

Approval Signatures

Step Description	Approver	Date
University Policy Review Committee	Stephanie Linares: Asst. Director University Compliance Services	01/2025
	Ramon Coto: Vice President, Chief Financial Officer, UHealth	01/2025
	Briana Spagnoli: Asst. VP, Finance Process Transformation	01/2025

Applicability

University of Miami, University of Miami Ambulatory Care Surgery, University of Miami Hospital and Clinics, University of Miami Laboratories, University of Miami Medical Group, University of Miami Miller School of Medicine

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Standards

No standards are associated with this document